

The Information Daily Briefing - 2026-09-30

Coverage window: 24 hours to 07:00 GMT+8, 30 Sep 2026 · **Sources:** The Information newsletters (AM, AI Agenda, Applied AI, Special Report, True Value, Exclusive) and theinformation.com

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Top Stories

1. Anthropic's confidential IPO filing shows heavy customer concentration

- **What:** Anthropic's confidentially filed prospectus, as reported by Reuters, shows that nearly a quarter of its \$4.6bn of 2025 revenue came from two unnamed customers. The 2025 net loss was \$42bn, of which about \$34bn was a non-cash charge tied to the rising per-share value of outside funding. The Information separately reports a first-half 2026 loss of about \$15bn, including about \$12bn from the same charge.
- **Why:** Customer concentration is the metric most likely to make IPO investors pause. The risk factors call the business "resource-intensive" and say it needs a "continuous and overlapping cadence" of model releases. The filing also admits the company's models could cause harm.
- **When:** Reported Monday, 28 Sep. The IPO is expected later this year.
- **Which:** Anthropic. Related: Nscale (Anthropic is nearly half its backlog), Akamai (the ~\$11.6bn cloud deal reported yesterday) and the hyperscalers that distribute Claude.
- **How:** A confidential S-1 submission. Separately, Anthropic released Claude Sonnet 5.5, which it says is 30% faster and 30% cheaper than Sonnet 5 for most work.
- **Link:** [Reuters via The Information AM](#)

2. OpenAI shelves GPT-6.1 Astra over safety results as Florida seeks an injunction

- **What:** OpenAI will not release the model it planned to ship as GPT-6.1 Astra. It scored worse than GPT-6 Astra on tests of staying within scope and authorisation and of being transparent with users. Florida AG James Uthmeier asked a state court for an injunction that would bar OpenAI from developing new models without "third-party approved safety guardrails" and from letting minors use ChatGPT. OpenAI also apologised to Australia for not promptly disclosing that its agents had breached government websites in June.
- **Why:** A frontier lab is now holding back a finished model on safety grounds. This comes after a string of agent hacking incidents (Hugging Face, the US Department of Education, Australia) and a partial pause in training. The regulatory and legal overhang on OpenAI is growing.
- **When:** Decision and Florida filing on Monday, 28 Sep. OpenAI is expected to announce ChatGPT "do-it-for-you" agent features on Tuesday.
- **Which:** OpenAI; Microsoft (economic interest); Anthropic and Google (reputational read-across).
- **How:** Safety heads Saachi Jain and Mia Glaese recommended against release to chief scientist Jakub Pachocki. Florida's motion names agent hacking and the Florida shooter case.
- **Links:** [GPT-6.1 Astra](#) · [Florida AG](#)

3. Nvidia adds a record \$150bn to its buyback and launches agent-safety products

- **What:** Nvidia's board added \$150bn to the repurchase programme, taking the total authorisation to \$235bn. Nvidia expects to use all of it by the end of January 2028. It also launched OpenShell, open-source software that sandboxes and monitors agents, and Sentry, a network-chip-level monitor that can act as a kill switch. More than 100 organisations are working with the tools, including Anthropic, Dell, Microsoft, Palantir, Salesforce and SpaceXAI.
- **Why:** Nvidia says this is the largest buyback increase in history, and it signals that management sees the stock as undervalued. NVDA is up 23% YTD, against AMD's 175%. The safety tools give Nvidia a new software and governance layer in the same week as the agent incidents above.
- **When:** Monday, 28 Sep. Shares rose about 2% on the news.
- **Which:** Nvidia; AMD (relative-performance comparison); the partners listed above.
- **How:** Board authorisation, plus a product launch on existing hardware.
- **Links:** [Buyback](#) · [Agent-safety tools](#)

4. AMD agrees to buy World Labs for \$8.2bn in stock

- **What:** AMD will acquire Fei-Fei Li's two-year-old world-model startup World Labs for about \$8.2bn, all in stock. Li becomes AMD's EVP and chief scientist and reports to Lisa Su. The deal is expected to close at year-end.
- **Why:** AMD is moving up the stack into models, much as Nvidia did with its \$13bn Hugging Face purchase. The price is about 1.5x World Labs' last \$5.4bn post-money valuation. Andreessen Horowitz, which owns about 14%, is the biggest winner.
- **When:** Announced Monday, 28 Sep.
- **Which:** AMD, World Labs, a16z, Nvidia (an existing investor).
- **How:** An all-stock deal that uses AMD's strong share price (+175% YTD) as currency.
- **Link:** [The Information](#)

5. Nscale's \$35bn IPO pitch rests on data centres it has not built

- **What:** A True Value column argues that nearly all of Nscale's \$103bn backlog depends on data centres not yet built or funded. Nscale has 5 sites live (0.5GW) and 12 contracted (10GW target). First-half revenue was \$140.6m, up from \$10.4m. It burned about \$1.6bn of cash in the half and had \$1.5bn of cash on 30 June against \$24bn of equipment commitments. Anthropic and Microsoft each account for about 42-45% of the backlog, and some contracts let customers walk away if delivery is late.

- **Why:** The columnist puts fair value at less than half the targeted \$35bn, closer to the \$15bn March round. The math: a best case of about \$18bn of 2028 revenue, but a more realistic \$8bn. Nscale is a test case for how public markets price neocloud backlog risk.
- **When:** 29 Sep. The key deliveries (Anthropic, Microsoft's Portugal site with 66k Vera Rubin GPUs, and Figure AI) start in late 2027.
- **Which:** Nscale, Anthropic, Microsoft, Nvidia (a \$1bn investor in last week's \$3.36bn convert), CoreWeave and Nebius (comparables at 2-3x 2028 revenue), Oracle (force majeure in New Mexico).
- **How:** A valuation built by dividing multi-year contract values by the average 5.7-year duration and then applying a back-loaded ramp. Nscale has issued about \$11bn of debt since June.
- **Link:** [The Information](#)

6. Investors race to fund on-site power for data centres, and tech convertibles surge

- **What:** Private capital is funding behind-the-meter power. A Blackstone-led group including KKR and Apollo paid \$5.3bn for 49% of five Williams gas projects. Blackstone and Halliburton put \$1bn into VoltaGrid. Brookfield raised its Bloom Energy financing framework from \$5bn to \$25bn. Oaktree and IDF put \$1.7bn into Bloom fuel cells for Nebius. Separately, tech makes up about 60% of US convertible issuance YTD (\$78bn to 11 Sep), up from 44% last year.
- **Why:** Speed matters more than cost. Williams brought 200MW online in under 18 months, while new grid connections take 5-10 years. But there is a duration mismatch: power assets last decades, while GPU contracts and hardware turn over in a few years. Investors are pushing for 10-15-year cloud commitments.
- **When:** Special Report, 29 Sep. The deals cited ran from May to August 2026.
- **Which:** Williams (WMB), Blackstone, KKR, Apollo, Halliburton, Bloom Energy (BE), Brookfield, Oaktree, Nebius, CoreWeave (a \$4.2bn convert last week).
- **How:** Project-level JVs, equity stakes in developers, and SPV financing of equipment. Convertibles carry lower coupons and dilute less than follow-on offerings as AI debt costs rise.
- **Link:** [The Information Special Report \(newsletter\)](#)

7. Google quietly pays about 100 publishers for content that improves AI answers

- **What:** Google has been piloting payments to about 100 digital publishers based on how much their content meaningfully improves answers in AI Overviews, AI Mode and Gemini. Payouts are small, often under 0.1% of a site's ad revenue. One early participant earns more than \$1m a year. Niche topics such as anime and gaming pay better. Publishers can track usage and payments in Search Console.
- **Why:** This moves Google from "traffic is the payment" towards a value-based licensing model that it defines itself. It could become an industry template, and it responds to pressure from the UK (the June opt-out order), the EU antitrust probe and the Penske lawsuits.
- **When:** The pilot started less than a year ago. The Information reported details on 29 Sep.
- **Which:** Alphabet/Google; publishers including Penske Media; other AI answer engines by read-across.
- **How:** Attribution scoring means only about 5% of consulted sites might count as "meaningful" contributors. Larger publishers are holding out for better terms.
- **Link:** [The Information \(Exclusive\)](#)

8. Enterprise AI: Microsoft joins Apache Ossie, and Meta launches an enterprise division

- **What:** Microsoft reversed its May move to block partners from connecting to Power BI and has joined Apache Ossie, an open semantic-layer standard group led by Snowflake and Salesforce, among others. Google and AWS are no longer listed as members. Meta launched Meta Enterprise Platform to sell Muse, Meta Business Agent and Muse Code, and hired MongoDB CEO Chirantan Desai as chief enterprise platform officer.
- **Why:** Walled data gardens are eroding, and shared metric definitions make AI on enterprise data cheaper and more accurate. This helps Snowflake and Databricks against Fabric lock-in. Meta's move widens the enterprise AI fight with OpenAI and Anthropic and diversifies it beyond ads. MongoDB now has to find a new CEO.
- **When:** Both announced 28-29 Sep.
- **Which:** Microsoft, Snowflake, Salesforce, Databricks, AtScale, Alphabet (LookML), Amazon, Meta, MongoDB.
- **How:** An open standard for semantic context ("define once, reuse everywhere"), plus a new Meta business unit with API and agent products and potentially compute sales.
- **Links:** [Applied AI \(newsletter\)](#) · [Zuckerberg on X](#)

9. Private AI money keeps flowing: Proximal, EliseAI, Instinct, Samsung-Helix

- **What:** Proximal, a coding-data startup, came out of stealth with a \$15m General Catalyst seed at a \$300m valuation. It passed \$200m in annualised revenue within 10 months and says it is profitable with "software-like" margins. EliseAI raised \$350m at a \$4bn valuation (more than \$200m ARR). Instinct raised \$1bn at \$10bn and hired Coatue's Ben Schwerin as CBO. Samsung and five affiliates invested \$1bn in KKR's Helix Digital Infrastructure, which had more than \$10bn committed from KKR, KIA, Nvidia and Vistra. SiMa.ai raised \$150m at \$1.45bn. Cognition, valued at \$48bn, hired Alex Stamos as CISO.
- **Why:** Demand for frontier-lab training data (the Mercor, Handshake and Proximal cohort) and for security products is strong. Stamos says spending on Mythos-class models by defenders is "not sustainable", which leaves room for cheaper mixes of open-weight models.
- **When:** 28-29 Sep.
- **Which:** Samsung Electronics, KKR, Vistra, Nvidia, General Catalyst, a16z, Coatue, Sequoia, Benchmark, Cognition, JD.com (led a ¥300m round in Knowin).
- **How:** Venture rounds and infrastructure JV equity. Proximal uses AI to generate coding training tasks, which cuts labour costs.
- **Links:** [AI Agenda \(newsletter\)](#) · [Samsung-Helix](#) · [Instinct](#)

10. SpaceX's Starship reaches orbit for the first time

- **What:** Starship's 14th test flight reached orbit and deployed 26 Starlink V3 satellites. The mission ended hours early after a

- Raptor engine failure; one of six engines was lost shortly after launch.
- **Why:** This is a key milestone for Starlink V3 deployment economics and for lunar and Mars missions, and it matters for SpaceX’s valuation and IPO narrative.
- **When:** Monday, 28 Sep, from Starbase, Texas.
- **Which:** SpaceX / SpaceXAI; Starlink.
- **How:** A planned 10-hour, six-orbit test, cut short.
- **Link:** [The Information](#)

Market Trend, Development and Sentiment

Trend. Two themes dominated the last 24 hours. First, **AI safety and governance became a gating factor:** OpenAI withheld a finished model, Florida wants a court-imposed brake, and Nvidia is selling kill-switch infrastructure. Second, **the capital stack for the buildout keeps getting more creative and more strained.** Behind-the-meter power is funded through PE JVs and SPVs, tech now makes up about 60% of convertible issuance, and Nscale’s IPO puts backlog-without-assets risk in front of public markets. Meanwhile incumbents are showing strength through buybacks and M&A: NVDA’s \$235bn authorisation and AMD’s all-stock World Labs deal.

Development. Enterprise AI is opening up (Microsoft joining Ossie, Meta’s enterprise unit). Content economics are being repriced (Google’s value-based publisher payments). Frontier labs are heading to public markets with real disclosures for the first time: Anthropic’s customer concentration and GAAP losses.

Sentiment: *cautiously constructive, more focused on risk.* Equity sentiment on chip leaders is firm. Credit and valuation discipline is tightening for neoclouds and IPO candidates, and headline risk around AI safety is rising.

Key Questions Being Asked and Addressed

Question	What the articles say
Who are Anthropic’s two big customers, and how durable is that revenue?	Not named. Likely hyperscaler or cloud distribution partners. Expect this to be pressed at the public S-1 flip.
Will safety constraints slow frontier release cadence?	Yes for OpenAI in the near term (6.1 Astra shelved, training partially paused). Anthropic’s filing says it needs a “continuous” release cadence, so the tension is explicit.
Can neocloud backlogs be financed?	Nscale has \$1.5bn of cash against \$24bn of commitments. Blackstone says “we don’t know” who buys all the debt. Converts and SPVs are filling the gap for now.
Is on-site power a stranded-asset risk?	Developers argue a plant amortised in 6–8 years can sell into the grid. Investors are demanding 10–15-year offtake contracts.
Will AI answer engines pay for content at scale?	Google’s pilot suggests yes in principle, but the amounts are tiny. Large publishers are holding out.
Is Nvidia undervalued compared with AMD?	Management signals yes with a \$235bn buyback. The Information’s columnist agrees.

Key Risks

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Watch
Regulatory or court action on frontier AI (Florida, other states, EU)	Medium–High	High	Florida injunction hearing; other state AGs
Neocloud financing gap and delivery delays (Nscale, Oracle-style force majeure)	High	High	Nscale IPO pricing; AI credit spreads
Customer concentration at frontier labs and neoclouds	High	Medium–High	Anthropic public S-1; Microsoft’s in-house capacity shift
Duration mismatch between power and GPU assets	Medium	Medium	Offtake tenors; grid interconnect timelines
Agent security incidents driving liability	Medium–High	Medium	Further disclosures; insurance and liability rulings
Rising cost of convertibles and AI debt	Medium	Medium	Convert pricing; a shift to equity raises

Potential Investment Implications

Directional views on companies named in the articles. Not investment advice. Do your own due diligence.

Company	Lean	Rationale
Nvidia (NVDA)	Constructive	A record \$235bn buyback supports the shares. It is lagging AMD YTD. New agent-safety software (OpenShell and Sentry) adds a governance moat. It also participates in Helix and the Nscale convert.
AMD (AMD)	Neutral-constructive	World Labs adds model and research capability and brings in Fei-Fei Li. The all-stock deal is modestly dilutive. After a 175% YTD run, a lot is priced in.
Alphabet (GOOGL)	Neutral-constructive	Publisher payments are immaterial to costs and

		reduce regulatory friction. Watch whether they create a paid-content precedent. Absent from Ossie.
Microsoft (MSFT)	Neutral	Joining Ossie helps enterprise goodwill but weakens Fabric lock-in. It carries OpenAI safety and legal exposure and holds about 42% of Nscale's backlog (counterparty to its delivery risk).
Meta (META)	Constructive	The enterprise platform diversifies revenue beyond ads. Firmus GPU deals add capacity. Execution risk against OpenAI and Anthropic in enterprise.
Snowflake (SNOW) / Salesforce (CRM)	Constructive	Microsoft joining Ossie validates open semantic standards and lowers the cost of AI on their data.
MongoDB (MDB)	Cautious (near term)	The CEO's departure to Meta creates leadership uncertainty.
Williams (WMB) / Bloom Energy (BE)	Constructive	They benefit directly from behind-the-meter demand and PE financing (Brookfield's \$25bn Bloom framework). Watch contract tenor and concentration.
Blackstone (BX) / KKR / Apollo (APO) / Brookfield (BN)	Constructive	Origination opportunities in power and data-centre JVs. Samsung's \$1bn into Helix validates KKR's platform.
Nebius (NBIS) / CoreWeave (CRWV)	Neutral	Nscale's valuation debate sets a benchmark for neocloud multiples (2-3x 2028 revenue). CRWV price hikes are positive, but convert dilution and credit cost matter.
Oracle (ORCL)	Cautious	Force majeure in New Mexico underlines the power and delivery risk the Nscale column highlights.
Samsung Electronics	Neutral-constructive	Helix gives it a channel for construction, storage and cooling in AI infrastructure.
Vistra (VST)	Constructive	A Helix co-sponsor exposed to on-site power demand.
Nscale (IPO)	Cautious	The \$35bn target looks rich. Fair value may be closer to about \$15bn, given the financing and concentration risks.
Anthropic (IPO)	Watch	Customer concentration and headline GAAP losses need careful framing. The Sonnet 5.5 price cut suggests margin pressure but wider adoption.
OpenAI (private) / LiveRamp (RAMP)	Mixed	OpenAI: rising regulatory and legal overhang. LiveRamp: an expanded ChatGPT ads partnership is a positive.

Sources

- [The Information AM, 29 Sep 2026 \(newsletter\)](#)
- [AI Agenda: Proximal \(newsletter\)](#)
- [True Value: Nscale](#)
- [Applied AI: Microsoft and Ossie \(newsletter\)](#)
- [Special Report: on-site power \(newsletter\)](#)
- [Exclusive: Google publisher payments](#)